

I

Where it all began

It was 8th of April 1997, Elijah was still just 4 years old when he heard shouting from downstairs, Elijah at that time couldn't hear what they were saying that well, then he heard running, suddenly his door burst open, it was his mom, she looked terrified with tears running down her eyes.

"Mom?" Elijah said while being a bit scared "Elijah, quickly hide!", as she closes the door and turns off the light, then his mom quickly grabs his arm and goes inside the closet to hide. The shouting gets louder, Elijah then wakes up

"That same dream again..".

Elijah looks at the time, it's 8:07 AM, then takes a deep breath and jumps out of bed to do his daily routine.

II

The *death* of Elijah

Elijah is now 24 years old and doesn't have a job, just barely scraping day by day, finding food or anything he could eat. Sometimes people feel pity for him and give him money for food and drinks, but rather than spending it on necessities like food and water, he spends it on alcoholic drinks or going clubbing with his friends. Elijah basically has lost all hope at this point, he keeps on blaming God for everything about his suffering eventually leading him to not believe in God growing resentment towards God, eventually he became so anti about God.

III

The early signs

One night he is going to a party with his friends, drinking and hanging out with people there. As usual, he keeps on chugging alcoholic drinks while talking to his friends, partying like normal. Then the party ended, Elijah and his friends went to ride on one of his friend's car named Jonathan, as they were driving to go back home suddenly a crow just crashed into Jonathan's car, the car instantly swerved out of control almost hitting a light pole.

"EVERONE OKAY?" Jonathan asked, well they were not to say the least.

"Yea.. We are fine, "said one of his friends.

"What did we just hit though?" Elijah asked.

"Well.. I really couldn't tell, nobody's hurt right?"

Jonathan said.

And then they drove off again, nobody really paid attention to what just happened and just brushed it off, but Elijah felt something was off about that encounter but just like his friends, he decided to just brush it off as a normal encounter, and so they went home acting like they almost didn't crash. But Elijah.. he still is a bit bothered by that, he felt strange.

"What was that earlier?" is the thought that kept on appearing on his mind so much so that he couldn't sleep, Elijah wanted to ignore the encounter, but something in his mind just couldn't make him ignore it, like screaming to Elijah to notice him, eventually Elijah was able to sleep.

IV

The Comforting poison

But on that same night, he dreamt about laying on a very comfortable bed, maybe even similar to sleeping on a cloud, he looks to his other side then he sees a prison cell, and turns out he was laying on a prison bed he was trapped in a cell, but it's open. Elijah, he's pretty confused asking to himself, why am I in a prison cell?

Thinking that he could just get out anytime, he thinks to himself

"Ah, I'll just get out later this bed's too comfortable to be left out" and he continues to lay on that comfortable bed.

But not long after he heard someone calling him, "Elijah, Elijah"

he ignores it, but that sound is heard again and this time it came with a warning.

"Elijah, when are you going to keep laying down and ignore the danger ahead? "

Elijah, then he said

"What danger? The door's fully open, it will never close, I will continue to lay down here and get out when I feel like it. "

Then *the voice* says,

"Not for long"

Then suddenly the prison cell shuts close and darkness fills the room and then Elijah wakes up, it is 3 AM. For the first time Elijah's dream was different, not the same repetitive traumatic childhood he had, but a weird one.

"Prison Cell? Why was i in a prison Cell" Elijah said,

he felt a bit shaken because Elijah still has questions, "Who was the Voice that talked to me? "What did that dream mean? "

V

The messenger

Elijah at this point can't sleep. He's still pretty shaken up, thinking about the dream but while Elijah was taking a break to process what had happened, suddenly he saw something on his window, a dove.

"A dove? Why is a dove here?"

Elijah gets out from his bed and walks towards the window, trying to look at it, maybe sneak in a bit of pats.

But before he could do it the dove flew away, showing off its graceful wings and its beauty.

"Wow, what a sight" Elijah said while being amazed, after that encounter suddenly Elijah's heart was filled with longing of something he turned around and looked at how miserable his life had been.

He devoted himself to fixing his life and turning himself around.

VI

Even God can rise people from the dead

So, Elijah decided to turn his ego down and arranged a meeting with a pastor at his local church, Elijah arrived there at 9:25 AM,

"25 minutes late but should be okay i guess" Said Elijah

And he opened the front door to the church, and as soon as he entered, he was instantly flooded by a sense of peace, a feeling he had never felt before. And after that Elijah went to the meeting place, 2nd floor of the church, he searched throughout the 2nd floor while looking at the church's interior and there at a distance he saw someone wearing a robe, Elijah then walked to him and asked

"Are you Pastor Benedict? "

"Yes I am, and you must be Elijah, right? " asked the pastor.

“Yea, I am Elijah, sorry i was a bit late”

“Ah, no worries, so what do you need help with? “

And from there Elijah told the story of how he wanted to turn his life around, and he specifically told the Pastor about the signs he has been experiencing.

After Elijah told all what happened to the pastor he chuckled and said

“Kid, you wouldn’t believe this but i used to be in your same position”

“How? You’re a pastor“Elijah asked

“Me being pastor doesn’t justify my past action, i used to be just like you, hopeless, thinking that life has no meaning anymore, but then i keep getting these signs, one time a raven came on to my window and bringing me bread, thats how i was able to live day by day”

“But what made you turn though? “Elijah wondered

“How I changed is because of one night, one important night, I couldn’t forget it. The night I personally encountered Jesus, and He told me to turn my life around and avoid the danger that’s ahead and after that, my life was never the same. “

“Maybe Jesus has been calling me all this time from the encounters that i have experienced”Elijah said

“Yes it is very likely that those signs aren't just coincidences but actual callings from God” Pastor Benedict continued.”

Then pastor Benedict offered to pray over Elijah, still carrying all the burden he has been carrying for years or even decades, so Elijah accepted the offering.

And pastor Benedict started to pray.

VII. Reborn

As Elijah was praying with pastor Benedict, he felt a presence, it was a very indescribable feeling but it was best to be described as a comforting warmth, like someone was hugging you, or standing near a campfire when it was cold. Then suddenly without any warning somebody pushed him, he fell but pastor Benedict caught him because he was behind Elijah while praying,

“Did you feel it? “ Pastor Benedict asked

“Yea.. i-it was like warmth and peace, now i feel more at peace”Elijah responded

“Great, what you just encountered was God's presence” Pastor Benedict said

“We shall continue on the counseling for next week at this place and at the same time alright”Pastor Benedict continued

“Thank you so much Pastor “ Elijah said while almost tearing up, because it was a feeling he couldn't ever get in his 20 years of life, and Elijah went home.

At night his friends asked him to go out again, you know partying and drinking, but Elijah refused

“Sorry dude, i don't wanna do those stuff anymore”

And they responded

“Dude what happened to you? “

And Elijah responded

“I don't wanna sin anymore, i want to turn my life around”

“Well, suit yourself”

“When did you became this lame? His friend responded with a mocking tone.

Elijah decided to cut contacts with them and read the Holy Bible that pastor Benedict gave him.